CAPABILITY METHODS LLC · SERVICES GUIDE

From AI-readiness clarity to a working platform

Three ways to work with us: diagnose where you stand, keep the roadmap moving, and build what matters. For executives and operations leaders at growing businesses.

Tier 1 Diagnostic · Tier 2 Fractional Transformation Leadership · Tier 3 Platform Project

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THE CHALLENGE

AI and operations decisions are getting made faster than they are understood

1

Everyone is asked about AI. Few have a clear starting point.

Boards, customers and staff want an answer. Most businesses do not yet know where they stand on data, process or governance.

2

Spending comes before understanding

Tools and platform changes get approved before anyone has checked whether the operation, the data or the controls are ready for them.

3

Plans stall without ownership

A good roadmap still needs someone senior to keep it moving, and someone to build it, without a full-time hire.

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OUR APPROACH

Senior, independent and built for businesses your size

1

Right-sized

Methods adapted from enterprise frameworks (ISO/IEC 42001, NIST AI RMF) and scaled for growing businesses. Not a six-month study.

2

A dedicated Principal Consultant

The same Principal Consultant scopes, delivers and reports at every tier.

3

Fixed and predictable

Fixed fees, written scope and clear caps. You know what you are buying before you sign.

4

Operations and AI together

We assess how the business runs and how ready it is for AI as one picture, not two separate projects.

5

Scoped around what you own

Recommendations start from the platforms and licenses you already have. Any chargeable add-on is flagged in writing, never assumed.

6

Built to hand off

Every engagement ends with something your team can run without us: a roadmap, a report or a documented build.

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THE OFFERING

Three tiers, one path from clarity to capability

1

TIER 1 · DIAGNOSE

AI & Operations Readiness Diagnostic

Where do we really stand, and what should we fix first?

Three to four weeks · fixed fee

2

TIER 2 · SUSTAIN

Fractional Transformation Leadership

Keep the roadmap moving with a senior advisor, without a full-time hire.

Monthly · up to 10 hours a month

3

TIER 3 · BUILD

Platform or AI-Readiness Project

Design and implement the platform or AI-readiness foundation you need.

Typically 6 to 12 weeks · fixed fee, 3 milestones

Fees are fixed, set by company size and scope, and set out in a written statement of work before you sign.

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TIER 1 · DIAGNOSE

The Diagnostic: five deliverables in three to four weeks

D01 Kickoff and alignment

Confirm objectives and scope; set the interview schedule.

D02 Current-state assessment

5 to 8 stakeholder interviews plus a review of existing tools and workflows.

D03 Gap analysis and findings report

Your top 3 to 5 blockers in plain English, each with business impact and a recommended action.

D04 Executive readout

A live walkthrough of the findings with your leadership team.

D05 Phased roadmap

What to fix now, next and later, usable with or without further help.

HOW IT WORKS

Fixed fee, set by company size

- Three to four weeks, start to finish
- 50% at signing, 50% at delivery
- No software cost
- No long-term commitment

Best for leaders who need an independent answer before they commit real budget to AI or a platform change.

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TIER 2 · SUSTAIN

Fractional Transformation Leadership: a senior advisor, every month

1

2 working sessions a month

60-minute sessions every two weeks that drive the roadmap forward.

2

Access between sessions

Quick questions answered without waiting for the next meeting.

3

A written monthly progress report

What moved, roadmap status, what is next, and hours used.

4

A quarterly roadmap review

Every third month: re-prioritize and confirm the value.

Two ways to start. Path A: after a Diagnostic, month 1 works from your existing roadmap. Path B: with no prior work, month 1 opens with a short current-state capture of about two weeks.

HOW IT WORKS

Monthly fee, set by company size and scope

- Up to 10 hours a month
- 3-month minimum term
- Then month-to-month, 30 days' notice
- Invoiced in advance

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TIER 3 · BUILD

Platform Project: three milestones, one clean hand-off

1

30% OF FEE

Milestone 1: Kickoff

Scope baseline approved, platform access confirmed.

2

30% OF FEE

Milestone 2: Midpoint

Design signed off and the core build demonstrated against its acceptance criteria.

3

40% OF FEE

Milestone 3: Final delivery

All deliverables accepted, hand-off package delivered, hand-off session held.

Four platform paths, one structure

- Google Cloud
- Open-source stack
- Your existing platform
- Salesforce

Fixed fee set by scope · typically 6 to 12 weeks · licenses and cloud costs are yours, and any chargeable add-on is flagged in writing before signing · includes a 30-day defect-correction window. Capability Methods is a Salesforce Partner; our advice stays vendor-independent.

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THE JOURNEY

Start where you are: every tier stands on its own

A

Not sure where to begin?

Start with the Diagnostic. In three to four weeks you have a scored picture, your top 3 to 5 gaps, and a Now / Next / Later roadmap.

B

Already know what needs doing?

Go straight to Tier 2 or Tier 3. A short, condensed current-state step comes first, using the same rubrics as the Diagnostic.

C

Finished a Diagnostic?

Your roadmap carries forward. Tier 2 or Tier 3 starts from it directly, with no repeat assessment.

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THE COMMON THREAD

One consistent yardstick runs through every tier

Operating Model Maturity · 4 dimensions

Customer and value focus, process discipline, team alignment and continuous improvement: how the business actually runs.

AI Readiness · 6 domains

Governance, data privacy, risk assessment, third-party AI, training and policy. Adapted from ISO/IEC 42001 and the NIST AI Risk Management Framework; an adaptation, not a certification.

Each scored on a 4-point scale

1

Crawl

Ad hoc, informal

2

Walk

Basic and repeatable

3

Run

Defined and managed

4

Fly

Optimized and embedded

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SIDE BY SIDE

Which tier fits? A quick comparison

	Tier 1 · Diagnose	Tier 2 · Sustain	Tier 3 · Build
Best when you…	Need an independent picture before spending	Need senior help keeping a roadmap moving	Know what to build and need it delivered
Duration	Three to four weeks	3-month minimum, then monthly	Typically 6 to 12 weeks
Fee	Fixed, set by company size	Monthly, set by size and scope	Fixed, set by scope
How you pay	50% at signing, 50% at delivery	Monthly, invoiced in advance	30% kickoff / 30% midpoint / 40% final
Our commitment	Five deliverables, including a live executive readout	Up to 10 hours a month, a written monthly report	Written scope, milestone acceptance, hand-off package
You walk away with	Scored findings, top 3 to 5 gaps, phased roadmap	A roadmap that keeps moving, with progress you can see	A working, documented build your team owns

Fees are set out in a written statement of work, with scope and dependencies, before you sign.

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BUILT-IN SAFEGUARDS

Predictable by design: cost, scope and exit are clear up front

1

Fixed fees, never hourly

Every tier has a fixed fee, set out in writing before you sign.

2

Written scope

Deliverables and acceptance criteria are in the agreement before work starts.

3

Capped hours

Tier 2 states up to 10 hours a month plainly, so expectations match.

4

Change-order discipline

Tier 3 work outside the agreed milestones goes through a written change order.

5

Light commitments

Tier 1 has no long-term commitment. Tier 2 is month-to-month after 3 months.

6

No surprise software bills

No software cost in Tier 1. Platform costs in Tier 3 are yours and flagged in writing.

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WHO YOU ARE WORKING WITH

A dedicated Principal Consultant

Mark Katanani, Principal Consultant, leads every engagement: scoping, delivery, reporting and hand-off. He brings 25+ years leading technology transformation in large enterprises.

TOGAF/DFSS **Lean Six Sigma Process Engineer** **SAFe Release Train Engineer** **U.S. patent holder, AI/ML-based defect prediction**

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NEXT STEPS

Let's find the right starting point

Tell us where you are, whether unsure, mid-roadmap or ready to build, and we will recommend the tier that fits. Start with the free 5-minute assessment, or book a free first conversation.

Capability Methods LLC

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